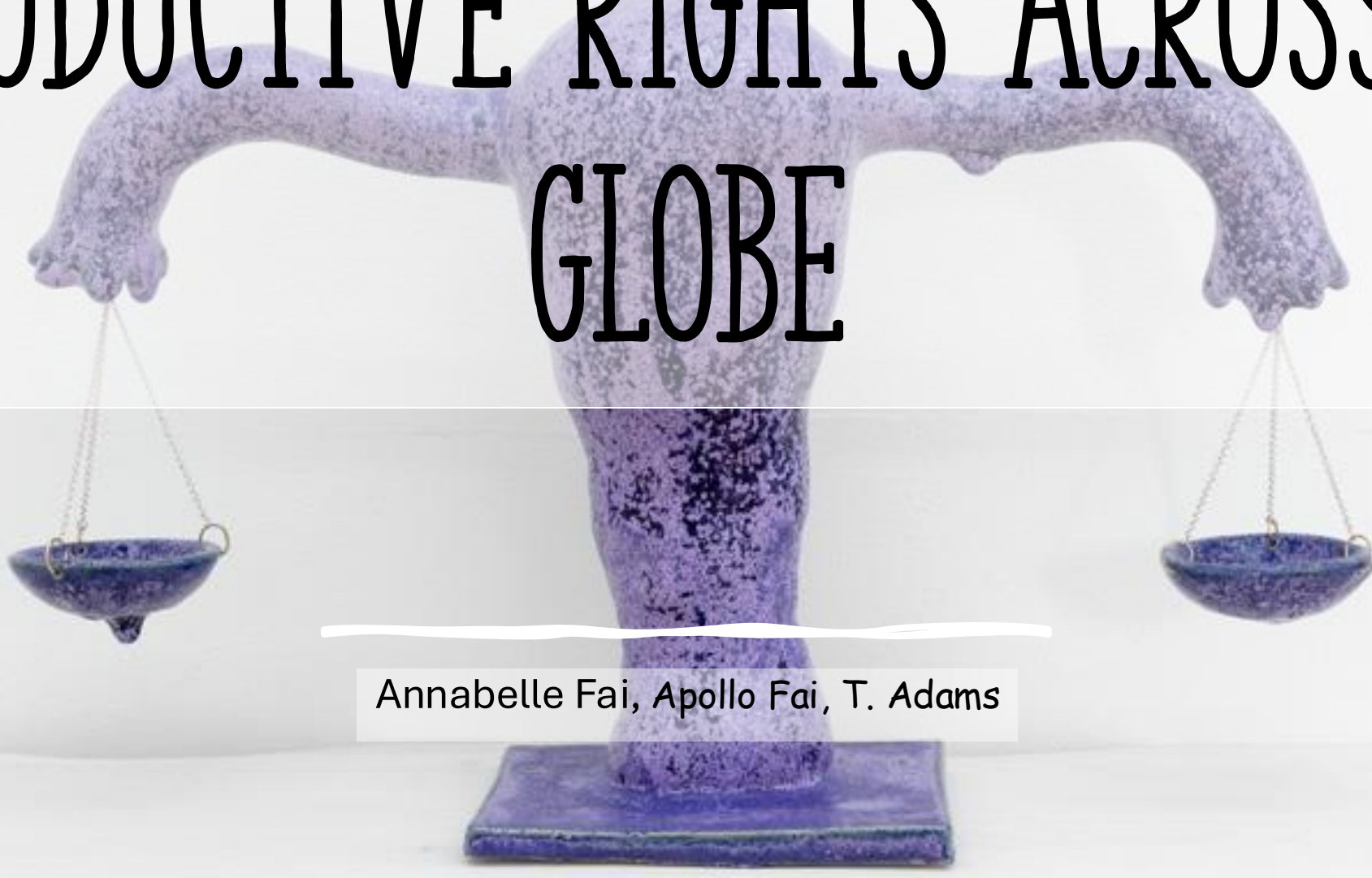


REPRODUCTIVE RIGHTS ACROSS THE GLOBE

A purple sculpture of a person with outstretched arms holding scales of justice, symbolizing global reproductive rights. The sculpture is positioned centrally, with the title text overlaid on it. The background is a light, neutral color.

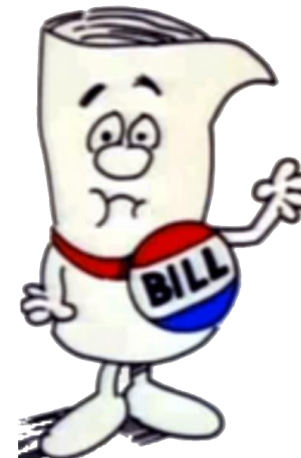
Annabelle Fai, Apollo Fai, T. Adams

ROE V WADE

- The Constitution protects a woman's right to an abortion, rooted in the right to privacy implied by the 14th Amendment.
- The Court argued that the right to privacy, encompassing reproductive decisions, is a fundamental right protected by the Constitution.
- Established a trimester framework for regulating abortion:
 - First trimester: Government could not regulate abortion.
 - Second trimester: States could regulate abortion to protect maternal health.
 - Third trimester: States could prohibit abortion, except when necessary to save the mother's life or health.

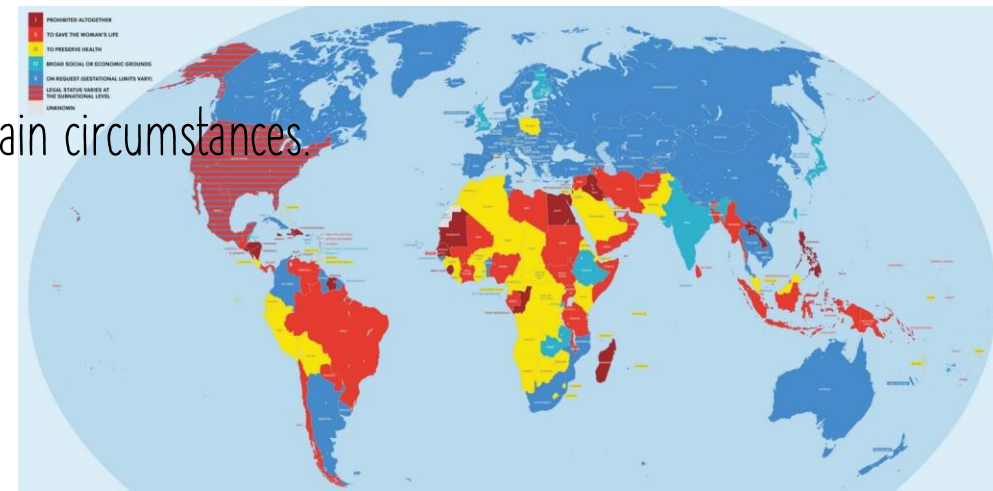
DOBBS V JACKSON

- The Constitution does not grant a right to abortion, and Roe and Planned Parenthood v. Casey are overruled.
- The Court found that the right to abortion is not a fundamental right and is not rooted in the Constitution's text or history.
- Returned the regulation of abortion to the states, allowing them to enact laws restricting or banning abortion as they see fit.



ABORTION RIGHTS UNIVERSALLY

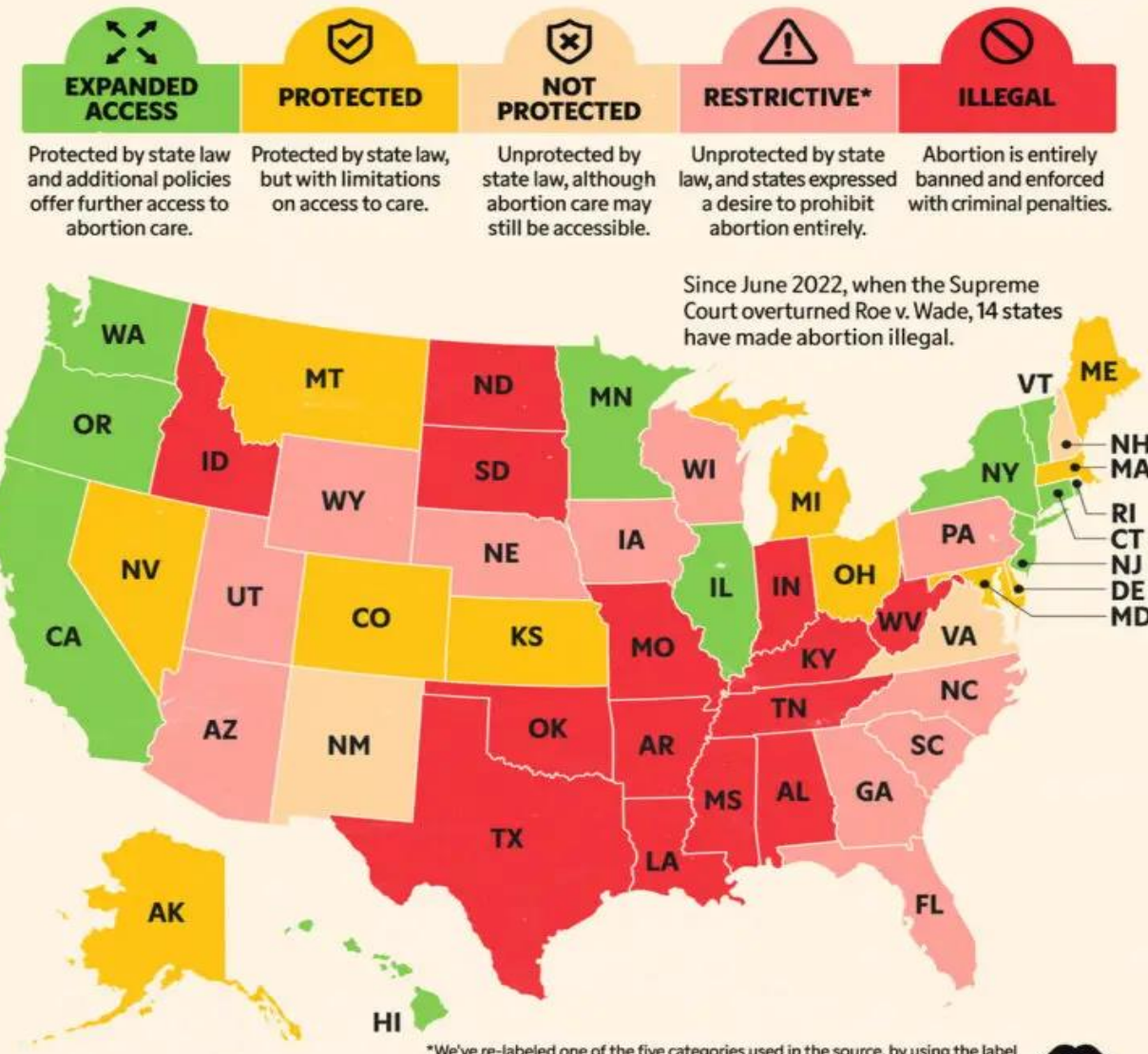
- The United Nations (UN) recognizes access to safe and legal abortion as a human right, essential for women's health and autonomy
- The World Health Organization (WHO) agrees, saying "Ensuring that women and girls have access to abortion care that is evidence-based...is fundamental to meeting the Sustainable Development Goals"
- While many states have banned abortion, and still more are considering it, there are many more which still guarantee it as a right, reflecting the recognized standard.
- Approximately 68 countries have legal abortion, whether outright, or in certain circumstances.
- Approximately 24 countries have it fully banned



STATES' RIGHTS

- Dobbs returned abortion policy to the states, leading to a patchwork of inconsistent laws across the U.S.
- Over a dozen states have enacted near-total bans, with some criminalizing providers and those seeking abortions.
- In states like Texas and Alabama, travel restrictions and legal penalties limit access, even across state lines.
- The results we have seen so far, in these states with strong restrictions, has been a drastic increase in maternal and infant mortality, and an increase in medical complications
- Over 200 women have been criminally charged post-Dobbs—including for miscarriages.

ABORTION LEGALITY BY STATE



*We've re-labeled one of the five categories used in the source, by using the label "Restrictive" instead of "Hostile", in order to enhance clarity and subject neutrality.
Source: The Center for Reproductive Rights

POLICY COMPARISON: U.S. (TEXAS) VS. CANADA



- Texas: Near-total abortion ban (Senate Bill 8), no exceptions for rape/incest, allows private citizens to sue providers. State-level policy.
- Canada: No criminal law restricting abortion; treated as a healthcare service. Federally regulated but delivered provincially.
- Policy Goals: Texas aims to protect fetal life; Canada prioritizes bodily autonomy and healthcare access.

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

OUTCOMES

TEXAS

- Extremely limited; excludes most pregnant people except under strict, narrow exceptions.
- Higher rates of preventable deaths, disproportionate harm to low-income people and BIPOC.

CANADA

- Broad access; no criminal barriers. Regarded as a healthcare right.
- Better outcomes for maternal health, fewer delays in care, more equitable service delivery.

REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH OUTCOMES IN TEXAS VS. CANADA

- Texas: High maternal mortality (37.1 per 100,000 live births in 2022)
 - Especially affects Black women.
- Canada: Lower maternal mortality (8.4 per 100,000); consistent access to reproductive care across provinces.
- In Texas, abortion restrictions have led to increased pregnancy-related ER visits and forced births with lethal fetal diagnoses.
- In Canada, abortion is often available at no cost

CONCLUSION

Reproductive rights are linked to health, autonomy, and equality.

Canada's model provides a blueprint for rights-based, health-focused policy.

U.S. states with restrictive laws face escalating health crises

Policy reform is urgently needed!

RESOURCES

- *Roe v. Wade*, 410 U.S. 113 (1973).
- *Planned Parenthood of Southeastern Pa. v. Casey*, 505 U.S. 833 (1992)
- *Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization*, 597 U.S. ____ (2022)
- Shalev, C. (1998, March 18). *Rights to sexual and reproductive health - the ICPD and the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women*. United Nations. <https://www.un.org/womenwatch/daw/csw/shalev.htm>
- World Health Organization. (n.d.). *Abortion*. World Health Organization. Retrieved April 22, 2025, from https://www.who.int/health-topics/abortion#tab=tab_1
- McPhillips, D. (2024, September 24). *Post-Roe, pregnant women face growing risk of criminal prosecution for charges much broader than abortion*. CNN. <https://www.cnn.com/2024/09/24/health/criminal-charges-during-pregnancy-increase/index.html>
- Texas State Law Library. (n.d.). *Abortion (Senate Bill 8)*. Texas State Law Library. Retrieved April 22, 2025, from <https://www.sll.texas.gov/faqs/abortion-senate-bill-8/>
- Government of Canada. (2023, March 31). *Abortion in Canada*. Public Health Agency of Canada. Retrieved April 22, 2025, from <https://www.canada.ca/en/public-health/services/sexual-health/abortion-canada.htm>